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REMOVABLE VEHICULAR WINDOW PANEL WITH INTEGRATED LATCHING ELEMENT AND CARRYING HANDLE

Abstract

A vehicular glass window panel assembly includes a glass panel. A handle and catch element is disposed at a first perimeter region of the glass panel and includes a handle portion and a catch. The catch is configured for engaging a latching element of a vehicle. A mounting pin is disposed at a second perimeter region of the glass panel opposite the first perimeter region. With the window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the mounting pin is received at a receiving portion of the vehicle and, with the latching element of the vehicle engaged with the catch, the window panel assembly is secured at the vehicle. With the latching element disengaged from the catch, the mounting pin is removable from the receiving portion and the window panel assembly is removable from the vehicle. The handle portion is graspable by a user to carry the removed window panel assembly.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/477,812, filed Sep. 29, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,304,286, which claims the filing benefits of U.S. provisional application Ser. No. 63/378,254, filed Oct. 4, 2022, which is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The present invention relates to openable/closable window panel assemblies for vehicles.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0003] It is known to provide a removable and/or openable/closable window panel assembly at a vehicle. The panels are attached via latches to the vehicle and can be removed.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] The present invention provides a removable glass window panel assembly for a vehicle, such as at a side or rear of the vehicle. The glass window panel assembly includes a glass panel having a pair of catches or catch portions that are configured to engage respective latches of the vehicle to secure the window assembly at the vehicle when the window assembly is disposed at an opening of the vehicle and the latches are moved to engage the catches. The glass window panel assembly includes a handle portion disposed between and integrated with the catch portions so that the window assembly may be readily carried by a user when the window assembly is removed from the vehicle. The integrated handle portion and catch portions are part of a single plastic injection molded (or otherwise formed) structure that is adhesively bonded at an inner side or surface of the glass panel.

[0005] These and other objects, advantages, purposes and features of the present invention will become apparent upon review of the following specification in conjunction with the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0006] FIG. 1 is an inner upper perspective view of a vehicular glass window assembly, showing the vehicle-based latching elements engaging the catch portions of the window assembly to retain the window assembly at a vehicle;

[0007] FIG. 2 is an inner lower perspective view of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. 1;

[0008] FIG. 3 is an inner plan view of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. 1;

[0009] FIG. 4 is an inner upper perspective view of the catch portions and handle portion of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. 1;

[0010] FIG. 5 is a top view of the catch portions and handle portion of FIG. 4;

[0011] FIG. 6 is a bottom view of the catch portions and handle portion of FIG. 4;

[0012] FIG. 7 is an inner side view of the catch portions and handle portion of FIG. 4;

[0013] FIG. 8 is an outer side view of the catch portions and handle portion of FIG. 4;

[0014] FIG. 9 is a perspective view of the catch and handle and latch mechanisms;

[0015] FIG. 10 is a sectional view of the window assembly showing the latching elements engaging the catch portions of the window assembly to retain the window assembly at the vehicle;

[0016] FIG. 11 is an inner upper perspective view of a vehicular glass window assembly, showing the vehicle-based latching elements engaging the individual catch and handle portions of the

window assembly to retain the window assembly at the vehicle;

[0017] FIG. **12** is an inner lower perspective view of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. **11**;

[0018] FIG. **13** is an inner plan view of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. **11**;

[0019] FIG. **14** is an inner upper perspective view of the individual catch and handle portions of the vehicular glass window assembly of FIG. **11**;

[0020] FIG. **15** is a top view of the individual catch and handle portions of FIG. **14**;

[0021] FIG. **16** is a bottom view of the individual catch and handle portions of FIG. **14**;

[0022] FIG. **17** is an inner side view of the individual catch and handle portions of FIG. **14**;

[0023] FIG. **18** is an outer side view of the individual catch and handle portions of FIG. **14**;

[0024] FIG. **19** is a perspective view of an individual catch and handle portion and respective latch mechanism;

[0025] FIGS. **20-23** are perspective views of an adjustable locator of the window assembly;

[0026] FIG. **24** is an exploded perspective view of the adjustable locator of FIGS. **20-23**;

[0027] FIGS. **25A** and **25B** are perspective views of a threaded adjustable pin of the adjustable locator;

[0028] FIGS. **26A-F** are views of threaded housing portions for the threaded adjustable pin of the adjustable locator;

[0029] FIGS. **27A** and **27B** are perspective views of a keyed adjustable pin of the adjustable locator;

[0030] FIGS. **28A-F** are views of a keyed housing for the keyed adjustable pin of the adjustable locator;

[0031] FIG. **29** is a perspective view of another adjustable locator disposed at a glass window panel of a vehicular glass window assembly;

[0032] FIGS. **30-33** are views of the adjustable locator of FIG. **29**;

[0033] FIG. **34** is a sectional view of the adjustable locator of FIG. **29**;

[0034] FIG. **35** is an exploded view of the adjustable locator of FIG. **29**; and

[0035] FIG. **36** is an exploded view of a housing and a washer having a sawtooth surface of the adjustable locator of FIG. **29**.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0036] Some vehicles have removable window panels to allow a user to remove the panels to provide a partially open side or rear or top. The window assembly may be attached at the vehicle via one or more pins at one perimeter region or edge region or end (e.g., a lower end) of the window panel and one or more latching elements at an opposite perimeter region or edge region or end (e.g., an upper end) of the window panel. When the latching elements at the vehicle are latched to or engaged with one or more respective catches of the window panel, the window assembly is held in place at the vehicle, and when the latching elements are unlatched or disengaged from the catches of the window panel, the window assembly can be removed from the vehicle.

[0037] Referring now to the drawings and the illustrative embodiments depicted therein, a glass window panel assembly **10** (FIGS. **1-3**) includes a glass panel **12** that is attachable or mountable at a side or rear portion of a vehicle via a plurality of latches or latching elements **14**. The latches **14** are attached at a frame portion or sheet metal portion of the vehicle that circumscribes or forms the opening that the window panel is positioned at when mounted at the vehicle. The window panel **10** has a perimeter seal or sealing element **16** disposed about its periphery to seal against the vehicle when the window is mounted at the vehicle. The latches **14** pivot or move to engage a respective catch portion **18** of a handle and catch construction or structure or element **20** that is bonded or adhesively attached at the inner side of the glass panel **12**. The window assembly includes a pair of mounting pins or locator pins **22** that are configured to be received in respective receivers or receiving elements at the vehicle, whereby the window panel is positioned at the opening of the vehicle and the catches **18** can be positioned at the latches **14**, such that the latches can be moved or

pivoted to engage the catches to secure the window panel at the aperture of the vehicle. The catches **18** are part of or integrated with a handle **24** of the handle and catch structure **20** of the window assembly so that, when the latches are disengaged and the window assembly is removed from the vehicle, the window assembly may be readily carried and stored via a user holding the window assembly via the handle **24**.

[0038] In the illustrated embodiment, the locator pins **22** of the window panel are adhesively bonded at a lower region or end of the window panel and spaced from the inner side or surface of the window panel **12**. For example, the locator pins **22** may be adhesively attached at respective spacers or protrusions disposed at the inner surface of the window panel **12**. Thus, when the window panel is disposed at the vehicle opening, the pins **22** are positioned to be received in the receiving elements of the vehicle that are spaced from the inner surface of the window panel **12**. With the pins **22** received at the receiving elements of the vehicle, the window panel is pivoted or moved into a closed position over the opening to position the catches **18** at an inner portion of the vehicle, with the latches positioned in their disengaged orientation. When the window is pivoted to the closed position, the latches **14** are pivoted or moved to engage the catches **18** to secure the window panel at the vehicle opening.

[0039] In other words, with the locator pins **22** along the lower edge region of the window panel **12** received at the receiving elements of the vehicle, the catches **18** along an upper edge region or end of the window panel **12** are positioned at or near or aligned with respective latches **14** of the vehicle. With the catches **18** aligned with the latches **14**, the latches **14** may be moved or pivoted into engagement with the catches **18** to secure the window panel at the vehicle. The latches **14** are movable or pivotable relative to the window panel and vehicle between a first or engaged position, where the latches **14** are moved or pivoted into engagement with the catches **18** and secure the window panel at the vehicle, and a second or disengaged position, where the latches **14** are moved or pivoted away from the catches **18** to release the window panel and allow the window panel to be removed from the vehicle.

[0040] The handle and catch structure or element **20** includes a plastic or polymeric element (such as formed via a plastic injection molding process) that is adhesively bonded at the inner side of the glass window panel **12**. As shown in FIGS. **8** and **9**, the structure is formed with a recess along the window panel attaching surface **20a** that receives the bonding adhesive and sets the bondline thickness of the adhesive to a desired or appropriate dimension.

[0041] The handle and catch structure **20** is formed with the handle or pocket portion **24** at a central region and the two catches or catch portions **18** at opposite ends of the structure. The catches **18** are formed as inner flat sections or surfaces **18a** at the end of the structure with inward ramped surfaces **18b** so that, when the latches **14** are pivoted to latch the window assembly at the vehicle, the latching elements **14** engage the respective ramped surfaces **18b** to draw the window panel tight against the vehicle and then the latching elements **14** engage the flat surfaces **18a** of the catches **18** to preclude outward movement of the window panel relative to the vehicle (FIGS. **4**, **5**, and **9**).

[0042] In other words, the handle and catch structure **20** may include a recess or cavity having an upward facing opening so that, when the latches **14** are pivoted into engagement with the catches **18**, the latches **14** pivot downward into the recess and engage an inner surface of a sidewall of the handle and catch structure **20** to pull the window panel toward the surface of the vehicle at the opening and the latches **14**. The recess of the handle and catch structure **20** receives the latches **14** as the latches **14** pivot from the disengaged position toward the engaged position and the latches **14** are guided along the ramped surfaces **18b** to the flat surfaces **18a** to urge the window panel toward the latches **14** in the engaged position.

[0043] The handle portion **24** provides a grasping portion of the structure to assist the user in pivoting the window panel to the closed position, whereby the user can hold the handle portion with one hand while pivoting the latching elements to the engaged orientation with the other hand. The handle portion **24** is formed as a rounded recess at the central region of the handle and catch

structure **20** to accommodate a user's fingers so that a user can readily grasp the handle portion **24** and pivot the window panel or to carry the window assembly when the window assembly is detached from the vehicle. The central portion of the handle and catch structure **20** at or near the handle portion **24** has a greater cross dimension or width than the catches, such that the ramped surface **18b** provides the ramped or curved transition between the central portion and the respective flat surface **18a** of the catch **18**.

[0044] The integrated handle and catch structure **20** thus extends between the two latches and provides a pair of latch catches **18** and a handle **24** for carrying the window and for pivoting the window panel into place when attaching the window panel to the vehicle. During installation of the window panel at the vehicle, the lower pins **22** are received at the receivers of the vehicle and then the window is pivoted to its closed position and the latches **18** latch the window panel in place. The latches **18** include manually pivotable latching elements that rotate to move the latching arm or element between the latching or engaged position (see FIGS. **9** and **10**) and the unlatched or disengaged or releasing position. When the latches **18** are released, the user can pivot the window panel outward and grasp the handle portion **24** and remove the window assembly from the vehicle and carry the window panel to a storage location. The integrated handle and catch structure **20** thus provides both a handle **24** and the catches **18** via a unitary plastic molding that is bonded to the inner side of the window panel. Although shown and described as having the catches or catch portions integrated with the handle, the window assembly optionally may have latch portions or latching elements disposed at the ends of the structure and integrated with the handle portion, whereby the latching portions are adjustable or movable to engage catches or catch portions at the interior portion of the vehicle when the window assembly is positioned at the vehicle opening.

[0045] Optionally, and such as shown in FIGS. **11-19**, the handle and catch may include separate spaced apart individual latch and catch portions **120**. That is, the window panel assembly may include a plurality of handle and catch structures **120** where the handle and catch structures are respectively disposed along the upper edge region of the window panel and spaced from one another. In the illustrated example, the window assembly includes two handle and catch portions **120** disposed along the upper edge region of the window panel and at opposite end portions of the window panel (e.g., at opposing upper corner regions of the window panel). The handle and catch portions or elements **120** are each formed with a handle or pocket portion **124** and a catch or catch portion **118**. Each handle and catch structure **120** includes a respective catch **118** configured to receive and engage a corresponding latch **14** at the vehicle. The catch **118** is formed as an inner flat section or surface **118a** at the structure with an inward ramped surface **118b** so that, when the latch **14** is pivoted to latch the window assembly at the vehicle, the latching element **14** engages the ramped surface **118b** to draw the window panel tight against the vehicle and then the latching element engages the flat surface **118a** of the catch **118** to preclude outward movement of the window panel relative to the vehicle.

[0046] The handle portion **124** provides a grasping portion of the respective element to assist the user in pivoting the window panel to the closed position, whereby the user can hold the handle portion with one hand while pivoting the latching element to the engaged orientation with the other hand. The handle portion **124** is formed as a rounded recess to accommodate a user's finger or fingers so that a user can readily grasp the handle portion and pivot the window panel or to carry the window assembly when the window assembly is detached from the vehicle.

[0047] Optionally, the locator pins may comprise adjustable locator pin assemblies or locators **122** (FIGS. **20-24**) that are attached at the glass panel and are adjustable to accommodate mounting tolerances and misalignments when mounting or attaching the window assembly at the vehicle. For example, and such as shown in FIG. **24**, the locator pin assembly **122** may include a housing having housing portions **122a**, **122b** that adjustably receive an adjustable pin **122c** to allow for vertical adjustment of the pin relative to the housing and the window panel. The locator pin assembly **122** also includes adjustment shims **122d** that are added or removed to laterally adjust the

housing relative to the window panel. The pin assembly **122** is attached at the window panel via a fastener **123a** that threadedly attaches to a window assembly nut **123b**. An appropriate or selected spacing (provided by the thickness of one of more shims **122d**) is provided by the shims **122d** between the housing and the window panel to position the pin relative to the window panel.

[0048] That is, the locator **122** includes a housing that attaches to the window panel via a threaded fastener **123a** that extends laterally through the housing and through the window panel and is received by or threaded into a nut **123b** at an opposite side of the window panel from the housing. The locator housing receives the pin **122c** that is axially adjustable relative to the housing, such as via threaded engagement between the pin **122c** and the housing. With the housing attached at the window panel, the pin **122c** is axially adjustable relative to the housing to adjust a vertical position (i.e., a position along a plane of the window panel) of the window assembly relative to the vehicle when the pin **122c** is received at the receiving elements of the vehicle. One or more shims **122d** are positioned between the housing and the surface of the window panel to laterally adjust the position of the housing and pin **122c** relative to the window panel and thus adjust a horizontal position (i.e., a position perpendicular to the plane of the window panel) of the window assembly relative to the vehicle when the pin **122c** is received at the receiving elements of the vehicle.

[0049] Optionally, and such as shown in FIGS. **25A**, **25B**, and **26A-F**, the adjustable pin **122c** includes a threaded pin that is threadedly and adjustably received in a threaded passageway of the housing (defined by partial threaded housing portions **122a**, **122b**). The threaded pin **122c** includes a threaded portion that is adjustably received along the housing, a locating post or pin portion that extends from the threaded portion to be received at a receiving element of the vehicle, and a seat or base portion between the threaded portion and the post to engage an upper or outer surface of the receiving element. Optionally, and such as shown in FIGS. **27A**, **27B**, and **28A-F**, the adjustable pin **222c** includes a keyed pin that is adjustably received in a keyed passageway of the housing (defined by keyed housing portions **222a**, **222b**). The keyed pin **222c** includes a keyed portion that is adjustably received along the housing, a locating post or pin portion that extends from the keyed portion to be received at a receiving element of the vehicle, and a seat or base portion between the keyed portion and the post to engage an upper or outer surface of the receiving element. The pins **122c**, **222c** are vertically adjustable relative to the housing by rotating the pins to adjust a degree of extension of the pin from the housing.

[0050] As shown in FIGS. **26A-F**, the outer housing portion **122b** includes positioning pins and the inner housing portion **122a** includes corresponding receivers to align the housing portions **122a**, **122b** during assembly of the pin assembly. Further, the outer housing portion **122b** includes flexible tabs that snap attach at receiving portions of the inner housing portion **122a** to secure the housing portions **122a**, **122b** together when assembled. The adjustable locator pin assemblies acts as the positioning locator pins for the bottom of the window assembly, and can be adjustable in both the up/down and in/out directions. The adjustable pin feature may be implemented on side windows or rear windows or backlites, depending on the particular window assembly and application.

[0051] Referring to FIGS. **29-36**, an adjustable locator pin assembly **322** may include a housing portion **322a** that adhesively attaches at the inner surface of the window panel and that includes a slot-shaped channel or passageway **322b** configured to accommodate the locator pin **322c**. As described further below, the locator pin **322c** extends axially along the passageway **322b** and away from the housing portion **322a** to be received by the receiving element at the vehicle, and the locator pin **322c** is laterally adjustable within the passageway **322b** to adjust the position of the locator pin **322c** relative to the window panel, and thus to adjust the position of the window panel relative to the receiving element at the vehicle.

[0052] The locator pin **322c** includes a threaded portion that is threadably received by a T-nut **326** or other suitable fastener element within the passageway **322b** and/or at an opposite side of the housing portion **322a**, where the locator pin **322c** and T-nut **326** are laterally adjustable within the

passageway **322b** and may be fastened or tightened together to set the position of the locator pin **322c** within the passageway **322b** (FIGS. **34** and **35**).

[0053] A tapered cap **322d** may be disposed at an end of the locator pin **322c** opposite the threaded portion, such as snap attached or press fit along the locator pin **322c**, with the cap **322d** configured to be received at the receiving element of the vehicle. The cap **322d** may be tapered to assist in locating the pin at the receiving element and for pivoting the window assembly relative to the receiving element.

[0054] As shown in FIGS. **32** and **36**, a lower surface of the housing portion **322a** facing the tapered cap **322d** may include a ridged surface portion or sawtooth surface portion **328** having a series of linear and parallel ridges or protrusions. A washer or spacer **330** having a corresponding ridged surface or sawtooth surface may be disposed between the cap **322d** and the housing sawtooth surface portion **328**. When the locator pin is moved laterally within the passageway **322b**, the sawtooth surfaces move along one another. When the locator pin is tightened to the T-nut **326**, the sawtooth surfaces engage one another and are urged toward one another, with the corresponding ridges or protrusions forming a detent interface that precludes lateral movement of the pin relative to the housing portion **322a**.

[0055] One or more washers or spacers or shims **332** may be disposed along the locator pin **322c** between the cap **322d** and the T-nut **326** to adjust the axial position of the pin relative to the housing portion **322a** and the window panel. Thus, the vertical position of the window panel relative to the vehicle may be adjusted via the addition or subtraction of one or more shims **332** between the cap **322d** and the T-nut **326** and/or sawtooth washer **330**.

[0056] Thus, a selected or desired or appropriate number of shims **332** are placed at the locator pin **322c**, and the locator pin is inserted through the washer **330** and through the housing **322a**. The T-nut is threaded onto the end of the pin and the pin and T-nut are moved laterally within the housing to position the end of the pin at the appropriate distance from the window panel, whereby the T-nut is tightened onto the pin to urge the washer **330** into engagement with the sawtooth surface portion of the housing and thus to secure the pin at the housing and window panel.

[0057] The glass window panel comprises a transparent glass panel. The glass panel may comprise any suitable material, such as transparent glass or polycarbonate or the like. Optionally, and desirably, the glass window panel may comprise a thin, strong glass material, such as GORILLA® Glass (commercially available from Corning Incorporated), which provides a lightweight and strong glass panel. Optionally, a ceramic frit layer or darkened layer or light absorbing layer **12a** or the like may be disposed at the glass panel **12** at locations where the perimeter seal and catch/handle is attached at, so that the seal and catch/handle are not viewable from exterior of the vehicle by a person viewing the glass panel of the vehicle from exterior of the vehicle (FIGS. **1-3**). The catch/handle may be adhesively attached to the inner side of the glass panel by utilizing aspects of the window assemblies described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 5,551, 197 and 5,853,895, which are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entireties. For example, the catch/handle may be bonded to the glass panel using any suitable adhesive, such as a one component urethane adhesive, such as a moisture cured adhesive, such as BETASEAL® or the like. Optionally, the window panel and handle and catch structure may comprise a unitary window panel with the structure and panel formed via a common injection molding process (such as by utilizing aspects of the window panels described in U.S. Pat. No. 8,881,458, which is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety).

[0058] The glass panel assembly provides a single glass panel that is removably or detachably attached at the vehicle via a plurality of latches. Optionally, the window panel assembly may utilize aspects of the window assemblies described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 8,915,018; 7,073,293; 7,003,916; 6,691,464; 6,026,611; 5,996,284 and/or 5,799,444, and/or U.S. Publication Nos. 2023-0070479; 2014-0047772; 2008-0127563; 2008-0106124; 2006-0107600; 2004-0020131 and/or 2003-0213179, which are all hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entireties. Optionally, the

glass panel may include one or more electrically conductive elements, such as heater grids or the like, which may be powered utilizing aspects of the window assemblies described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 8,881,458 and/or 8,402,695, which are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entireties. Electrical connection to the heater grids may be made via electrical connection to a vehicle power source at one or both pins or latching elements or other electrical contact between electrically conductive traces or elements at the window panel and corresponding contacts at the vehicle. [0059] Changes and modifications to the specifically described embodiments may be carried out without departing from the principles of the present invention, which is intended to be limited only by the scope of the appended claims, as interpreted according to the principles of patent law.

Claims

1. A vehicular glass window panel assembly, the vehicular glass window panel assembly comprising: a glass panel having an inner side and an outer side, wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at a vehicle equipped with the vehicular glass window panel assembly, the inner side faces an interior cabin of the vehicle and the outer side faces exterior the vehicle; a handle and catch element disposed at a first perimeter region of the glass panel; wherein the handle and catch element comprises a handle portion and a catch, and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the catch is configured for engaging a latching element of the vehicle; a mounting pin disposed at a second perimeter region of the glass panel, wherein the second perimeter region is opposite the first perimeter region; wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the mounting pin is received at a receiving portion of the vehicle; wherein, with the mounting pin received at the receiving portion of the vehicle, and with the latching element of the vehicle engaged with the catch, the vehicular glass window panel assembly is secured at the vehicle; wherein, with the latching element of the vehicle disengaged from the catch, the mounting pin is removable from the receiving portion of the vehicle and the vehicular glass window panel assembly is removable from the vehicle; and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly removed from the vehicle, the handle portion is graspable by a user to carry the vehicular glass window panel assembly.
2. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the handle and catch element is disposed at the inner side of the glass panel.
3. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 2, wherein the handle and catch element is adhesively bonded at the first perimeter region of the inner side of the glass panel.
4. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the mounting pin is disposed at the inner side of the glass panel.
5. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the handle and catch element is formed as a single component via a plastic injection molding process.
6. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the catch comprises a (i) first catch formed at a first end of the handle and catch element and (ii) a second catch formed at a second end of the handle and catch element, and wherein the first end is opposite the second end.
7. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 6, wherein the handle portion is disposed at a central portion of the handle and catch element between the first catch and the second catch.
8. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 7, wherein the central portion has a cross dimension that is greater than respective cross dimensions of the first catch and the second catch, and wherein respective ramped surfaces are formed between the central portion and the first catch and the second catch.
9. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, comprising (i) a first handle and catch element disposed at a first side region of the inner side of the glass panel and (ii) a second handle and catch element disposed at a second side region of the inner side of the glass panel, and wherein

the first side region is opposite the second side region.

10. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, further comprising a perimeter sealing element disposed along a periphery of the glass panel.

11. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the mounting pin comprises a pair of mounting pins.

12. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the mounting pin comprises an adjustable pin assembly having a pin that is adjustable relative to the glass panel along a longitudinal axis of the pin.

13. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 12, wherein the adjustable pin assembly is laterally adjustable relative to the glass panel in a direction perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the pin.

14. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 1, wherein the handle and catch element comprises an attaching surface that comprises a recessed portion for receiving adhesive therein to adhesively bond the handle and catch element at the inner side of the glass panel.

15. A vehicular glass window panel assembly, the vehicular glass window panel assembly comprising: a glass panel having an inner side and an outer side, wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at a vehicle equipped with the vehicular glass window panel assembly, the inner side faces an interior cabin of the vehicle and the outer side faces exterior the vehicle; a handle and catch element disposed at a first perimeter region of the glass panel; wherein the handle and catch element comprises a handle portion and a catch, and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the catch is configured for engaging a latching element of the vehicle; a pair of mounting pins disposed at a second perimeter region of the glass panel, wherein the second perimeter region is opposite the first perimeter region, and wherein the pair of mounting pins comprises (i) a first mounting pin disposed at the second perimeter region of the glass panel and (ii) a second mounting pin disposed at the second perimeter region of the glass panel spaced from the first mounting pin; wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the first mounting pin is received at a first receiving portion of the vehicle and the second mounting pin is received at a second receiving portion of the vehicle; wherein each mounting pin of the pair of mounting pins comprises an adjustable pin assembly having a pin that is adjustable relative to the glass panel along a longitudinal axis of the pin of the respective adjustable pin assembly; wherein, with the first mounting pin received at the first receiving portion of the vehicle, and with the second mounting pin received at the second receiving portion of the vehicle, and with the latching element of the vehicle engaged with the catch, the vehicular glass window panel assembly is secured at the vehicle; wherein, with the latching element of the vehicle disengaged from the catch, the first mounting pin is removable from the first receiving portion of the vehicle, the second mounting pin is removable from the second receiving portion of the vehicle and the vehicular glass window panel assembly is removable from the vehicle; and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly removed from the vehicle, the handle portion is graspable by a user to carry the vehicular glass window panel assembly.

16. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, wherein the handle and catch element is disposed at the inner side of the glass panel.

17. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, wherein the pair of mounting pins are disposed at the inner side of the glass panel.

18. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, wherein the catch comprises (i) first catch formed at a first end of the handle and catch element and (ii) a second catch formed at a second end of the handle and catch element, and wherein the first end is opposite the second end.

19. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, comprising (i) a first handle and catch element disposed at a first side region of the inner side of the glass panel and (ii) a second handle and catch element disposed at a second side region of the inner side of the glass panel, and wherein

the first side region is opposite the second side region.

20. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, further comprising a perimeter sealing element disposed along a periphery of the glass panel.

21. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 15, wherein each adjustable pin assembly is laterally adjustable relative to the glass panel in a direction perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the pin of the respective adjustable pin assembly.

22. A vehicular glass window panel assembly, the vehicular glass window panel assembly comprising: a glass panel having an inner side and an outer side, wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at a vehicle equipped with the vehicular glass window panel assembly, the inner side faces an interior cabin of the vehicle and the outer side faces exterior the vehicle; a handle and catch element disposed at a first perimeter region of the inner side of the glass panel; wherein the handle and catch element comprises (i) a first catch formed at a first end of the handle and catch element, (ii) a second catch formed at a second end of the handle and catch element that is opposite the first end and (iii) a handle portion formed between the first catch and the second catch, and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the first catch is configured for engaging a first latching element of the vehicle and the second catch is configured for engaging a second latching element of the vehicle; wherein, with the first latching element of the vehicle engaged with the first catch, and with the second latching element of the vehicle engaged with the second catch, the vehicular glass window panel assembly is secured at the vehicle; wherein, with the first latching element of the vehicle disengaged from the first catch, and with the second latching element of the vehicle disengaged from the second catch, the vehicular glass window panel assembly is removable from the vehicle; and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly removed from the vehicle, the handle portion is graspable by a user to carry the vehicular glass window panel assembly.

23. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 22, wherein a mounting pin is disposed at a second perimeter region of the glass panel, and wherein the second perimeter region is opposite the first perimeter region, and wherein, with the vehicular glass window panel assembly mounted at the vehicle, the mounting pin is received at a receiving portion of the vehicle.

24. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 22, wherein the handle and catch element is formed as a single component via a plastic injection molding process.

25. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 22, wherein the handle portion is disposed at a central portion of the handle and catch element between the first catch and the second catch, and wherein the central portion has a cross dimension that is greater than respective cross dimensions of the first catch and the second catch, and wherein respective ramped surfaces are formed between the central portion and the first catch and the second catch.

26. The vehicular glass window panel assembly of claim 22, further comprising a perimeter sealing element disposed along a periphery of the glass panel.
